

</p>

❷ {% block content %}{% endblock content %}

The first part of this file creates a paragraph containing the name of the project, which also acts as a home page link. To generate a link, we use a *template tag*, which is indicated by braces and percent signs ({% %}). A template tag generates information to be displayed on a page. The template tag {% url 'learning_logs:index' %} shown here generates a URL matching the URL pattern defined in *learning_logs/urls.py* with the name 'index' ❶. In this example, *learning_logs* is the *namespace* and *index* is a uniquely named URL pattern in that namespace. The namespace comes from the value we assigned to *app_name* in the *learning_logs/urls.py* file.

In a simple HTML page, a link is surrounded by the *anchor tag* <a>:

link text

Having the template tag generate the URL for us makes it much easier to keep our links up to date. We only need to change the URL pattern in *urls.py*, and Django will automatically insert the updated URL the next time the page is requested. Every page in our project will inherit from *base.html*, so from now on, every page will have a link back to the home page.

On the last line, we insert a pair of block tags ❷. This block, named *content*, is a placeholder; the child template will define the kind of information that goes in the *content* block.

A child template doesn't have to define every block from its parent, so you can reserve space in parent templates for as many blocks as you like; the child template uses only as many as it needs.

NOTE

In Python code, we almost always use four spaces when we indent. Template files tend to have more levels of nesting than Python files, so it's common to use only two spaces for each indentation level.

The Child Template

Now we need to rewrite *index.html* to inherit from *base.html*. Add the following code to *index.html*:

index.html ❶ {% extends 'learning_logs/base.html' %}

❷ {% block content %}

<p>Learning Log helps you keep track of your learning, for any topic you're interested in.</p>

❸ {% endblock content %}

If you compare this to the original *index.html*, you can see that we've replaced the Learning Log title with the code for inheriting from a parent template ❶. A child template must have an {% extends %} tag on the first line to tell Django which parent template to inherit from. The file *base.html*